

DELHI | Up and Out

Margaret Alva may have lost the Lok Sabha polls but the Sonia loyalist has been rehabilitated as the governor of Rajasthan. But is the posting a prize or a punishment? Alva would probably have preferred the Raj Bhavan in Maharashtra as she has been playing an active role in its state politics ever since she was the general secretary in-charge. Congress leaders, however, say that this is the very reason that Alva has been kept out of Maharashtra. "She played factional politics and used to promote Narayan Rane over then chief minister Vilasrao Deshmukh," recalls a party general secretary. Moreover, a reshuffle at the Congress headquarters is also on the cards. Last year Alva resigned as general secretary over allegations of 'selling' tickets during the Karnataka polls, a charge which did not go down well with her colleagues. Yet, Alva's proximity to Sonia Gandhi makes it difficult to sideline her. So a governorship seemed the best way out.

by Priya Sahgal



SHIPRA DAS

BANGALORE | Bill of Lights

The power bill for illuminating Karnataka's government buildings has arrived like a sudden short circuit. It has come to light that the Vidhana Soudha, Vikas Soudha and the Visveswaraya tower—all near the state Secretariat—ran up an electricity bill of Rs 11.68 crore between December 2005 and January 2008. The Vidhana Soudha is the largest post-Independence secretariat in south India and the Vikas Soudha, its mirror image, was opened in February 2005. No matter how much they love these fine structures, the cost of lighting them up will not amuse the citizens of a state grappling with severe power shortages.

by Stephen David



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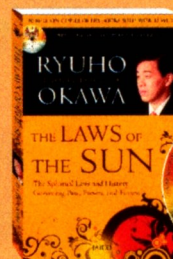
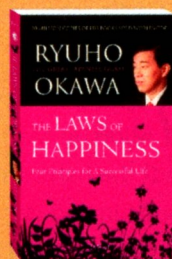
RYUHO
THE GREAT JAPANESE GURU
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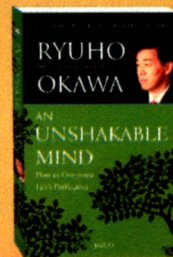
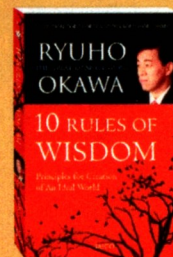
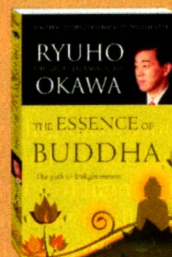
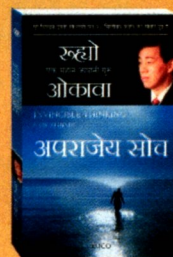
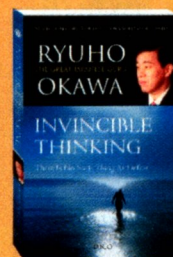
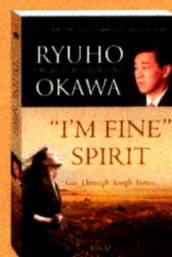
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